

are over 1,200 public-listed large enterprises in India with a current IoT adoption rate of around 35%. The Zinnov study also discloses that India is one of the richest talent ecosystems for IoT, with 30,000 to 40,000 professionals dedicatedly working on this technology. Yet, experts feel that the adoption rate is much slower than any report on IoT has anticipated so far.

Where the problem lies

The problem lies both on the seller as well as on the buyer side. People are always excited to talk about IoT and its implementation but deals between sellers and buyers do not close that easily. Sellers should focus more on IoT solutions as a business case development concept rather than as a business development concept.

“The business development cases give IT heads and CTOs a reason to push through to have internal teams on the same page of implementing IoT. I talk to people who have a lot of fancy use cases, but nothing has made money,” notes Amit Satpathy, EVP & Head, Vodafone Idea IoT Business.

Additionally, different sellers might also be confusing customers with different technologies and models. There is a good number of IoT sellers available in the market, and this simply means that customers have a lot of technologies and use cases to choose from. However, a lot of options in the technology might be confusing buyers more than they are helping them decide. What adds more worries to the extended list of options is the fact that only a few focus on what the customer wants to achieve through the IoT. So much so that even the good ones appear to be under the same shade as ones promising fancy use cases.

“Going through so many technologies makes the buyer think about how soon they will mature more. The customers simply say that they will wait for the technology to get more mature before making a decision. As nobody’s focusing on the outcome, and the buyer is thoroughly confused, they keep postponing their decision saying, okay, fine. Let me gain more knowledge. Let this thing mature,” explains Amit.

Then comes the apprehension

The problems

1. Each client has a unique need, which limits the previous use cases and proof of concept
2. Pitching solutions that do not offer at least five times return on investment (5x RoI)
3. Too much focus on product innovation but too less focus on after-sales services innovation
4. Pitching flawlessly, executing flaw-fully
5. Offering services PAN India but having a poor service capability
6. Becoming R&D centres for big organisations

How to solve the IoT adoption problem?

1. Creators should focus on IoT as a business case development concept rather than a business development case
2. IoT providers should not confuse potential clients with different technologies
3. Customers should be encouraged to implement IoT at the core of their operations
4. IoT developers can work together with enablers and customers to create solutions
5. In co-creation of IoT solutions, one company should be entirely responsible for service to the customer
6. Advising the customer on how to monetise the data generated by machines

Three approaches

1. Under My Shop. The creator develops end-to-end solutions under his shop. Not recommended by experts.
2. Cocreate Post Requirements. The creator collaborates with partners after understanding the needs of a customer. Somewhat recommended.
3. Pre Partnerships and Collaborations. The creator has already entered collaborations with industry partners. Highly recommended.

associated with implementing Industry 4.0 measures in an organisation. Many organisations looking to benefit from Industry 4.0, commonly referred to as IIoT, do not want the technology implemented at the core of their operations. Instead, they tend to get these solutions implemented in areas where there are a lot of individuals working already. These solutions end up facing resistance from people who have already been working in that domain.

“If you see the setup of a large organisation, you will notice that the guy who enjoys a lot of power is usually sitting in a remote area, and the problem arises when this leader starts feeling that he will get redundant, and the problem amplifies when his team starts feeling that they will also get redundant,” notes Amit.

One solution for this can be to inform the customer at the stage when he wants the answer to where he should start in terms of implementing IoT. That, as per Amit, is the golden question that can break the ice between the seller and the buyer. Amit is also of the view that the next five

months, in terms of IoT implementation, will not be the same as the last five years. The outbreak of Covid-19 has made businesses engage in a fight for survival, and IoT is now being seen as a major weapon to win this fight.

Cementing what Amit explained, a report by Markets and Markets notes that the global impact of Covid-19 on the IoT market size is expected to grow from \$150 billion in 2019 to \$243 billion by 2021 at compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 13.7% during the forecast period. The report also predicts that the countries falling under the APAC region including India, China, and Australia will showcase a huge base amidst the Covid-19 outbreak. For the record, countries in APAC accounted for more than 42% of the total installed smart meters in 2018.

Next in line as a problem affecting the adoption of IoT is the affordability parameter. There are reports claiming that there are billions of connected devices already existing on the planet. Such reports also hint at IoT market being an opportunity upwards of \$10 billion. However, the irony, as per